[TITLE]

[OWNER: full name] · San Francisco · a concept for Amsterdam Light Festival, Edition 16

The work

A globe two metres across, drawn in light: an armillary sphere of the Earth, made of colour.

It is made of six discs of cast acrylic, each tinted all the way through in one colour:

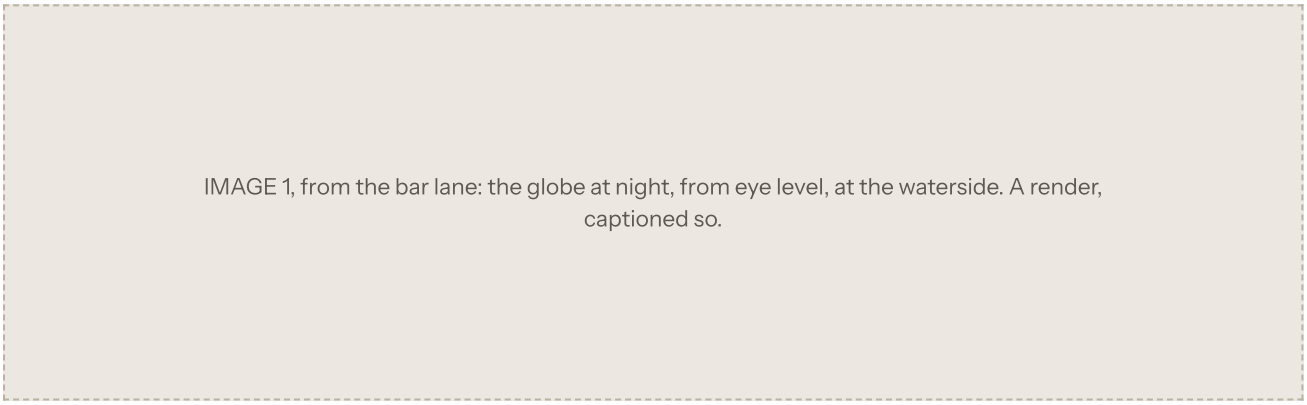
- **Three meridians**, in green, orange and violet, stand on edge and cross at the poles.
- **Three parallels**, in red, blue and yellow, ring them at the equator and at forty degrees north and south.

The discs are slotted into one another where they cross, so the globe is open: you see through it, and through one colour into the next. Its axis leans 23.4 degrees, as the Earth's does.

By day it is a piece of coloured glass the size of a small room. The sun goes through each disc and throws its colour on the ground, and where two discs cross the colours mix.

At night the rims glow. A slim line of light runs in a groove along each disc's outer edge, under a polished acrylic cap, so the rim shines in the disc's own colour while the faces stay dark and clear. Six lines of colour, each the circle of its disc, draw the globe in the air. One hard spot, low across the quay, throws the globe's shadow: rings inside rings, each in its own colour, laid over the paving and the water.

There's no screen, no projection and no moving part. The light is steady, and the work is the material doing what it does: one object, drawn three times, in its rims, on the quay and in the canal.



The idea

[THEME: Edition 16's theme, from the artist briefing. One paragraph that reads the work through it, written once the theme is known. Hold to what the work is: a model of the planet you can stand inside the light of, made from one material in six colours.]

A globe is the oldest way of holding the whole world in front of you. Most globes are solid: a surface of countries with nothing inside. This one is only lines, the meridians and the parallels, the grid we drew on the planet to find our way around it. With the surface gone, the light is what's left, and you can look straight through the world to the city on the other side.

Each line is its own colour, and none is the "right" one. Walk round it, and the colours in front pass over the ones behind and mix, so the globe changes with every step.

[OWNER: one or two sentences of your own: why a globe, and why light that comes from inside the material rather than being shone onto it. Keep it in your voice; the jury reads this for "relation to the artist statement".]

How the public meets it

- **From a distance.** On the canal route, the globe reads first as six coloured circles hanging in the dark, from a boat or from the far quay. Water doubles it: every rim is drawn a second time, broken up, on the canal below.
- **Close to.** The globe stands at the waterside on a low plinth, its lowest point about 0.55 m above the ground, so people can walk round it and look up through it. The polished edges are lit; the faces are cool and clear.
- **Through it.** Stand on the far side and the city appears through the discs, tinted: a bridge in yellow, a facade in violet. Phones will do the rest: the picture everyone takes is the city framed by the world.

- **Its shadow.** The spot lays the globe flat on the quay in coloured rings, long and low. Walking through it puts the colours on your coat, and the rings ride on the canal's surface beyond. By day, the low winter sun does the same.
- **For everyone.** It's silent and steady: no flashing, no strobe, nothing that startles. The light level is [to be set with the festival's technicians] for the site, so it sits among the canal's own lights rather than over them.

IMAGE 2, from the bar lane: the hard spot's coloured shadow on the quay and the water. A render, captioned so.

Materials and making

- **The discs.** Cell-cast acrylic sheet, 25 mm thick, tinted through in six colours. Each disc is cut flat by CNC (in two bonded halves where the sheet is narrower than the disc), slotted, grooved along its rim and edge-polished. The discs are about 485 kg together. On site they slot together on the armature, with 2 mm of play in each slot.
- **The light.** A 24 V side-emitting LED strip, sealed to IP67, in a 6 mm groove along each rim under a polished acrylic cap: about 35 m of rim in all. Run at about half power for the canal, about 175 W. One IP65 LED profile spot of 150–250 W, on a 6 m mast or a facade bracket about 9 m away, throws the shadow. The drivers (IP67, 24 V, fused) and a timer and DMX controller sit in the plinth, away from the water. In all, about 0.4–0.6 kW connected and about 3.5 kWh a night: about the same as two outdoor floodlights. A 300 mm rim-lit test globe proves the light before the sheet is bought.
- **The structure.** A blackened steel drum, 1.5 m across and 0.45 m high, holds the armature the discs slot onto. It carries about 1.0–1.8 t of ballast in all (the globe's own weight counts toward it), hired in Amsterdam as steel or concrete blocks, to a Dutch structural engineer's figure for the site (Eurocode EN 1991-1-4). Nothing is drilled into the quay unless the festival prefers it.
- **Made in.** [OWNER: where. The bar lane's sheet suggests the Netherlands, with sheet from a European caster, as the cheapest sound route, so the work travels by van rather than container.]

IMAGE 3, from the bar lane: the technical drawing: plan, elevation, the plinth and its ballast, dimensions.

Two months outdoors

The work is built for an Amsterdam winter, from late November to mid-January, and the plan answers each risk.

Risk	The answer
Rain, frost, damp	Acrylic doesn't rust or rot, and takes up only a little water. The LEDs, their connections and the drivers are sealed to IP67; the rim grooves drain at their low points; the plinth is vented
Wind	Flat discs catch more wind than a sphere of the same size, so the plinth is built for it: about 1.0–1.8 t of ballast for gusts of 30–40 m/s (est.), to a Dutch structural engineer's calculation for the site

	under Eurocode EN 1991-1-4, signed off before installation. The 25 mm discs and their slotted joints are checked for the 2–3 kN each takes face-on
Cold, damp and movement	Acrylic moves more than metal: about 0.07 mm per metre for each degree, so a 2 m disc grows or shrinks about 1.5 mm over a 20 °C swing, and a little more as it takes up damp. The slots have 2 mm of play and the armature's clamps float, so the discs move without stress
Colour over time	The discs are cut flat, not heat-formed, from colour-stable cast sheet. The maker's colour guarantee covers flat sheet outdoors (it doesn't cover sheet that has been formed), and two months is well within it
Knocks and climbing	Cast acrylic is far tougher than glass and doesn't break into shards. At 0.55 m the lowest point and the open discs invite climbing, so the work assumes a low barrier ring about 1 m out and the festival's stewarding [to agree with the festival]
Cleaning	Water and a mild soap only, never solvents or glass sprays, which craze acrylic. A cleaning sheet goes to the festival's crew
Nuisance	None: no sound, no smoke, no lasers, no flashing. The light points inward and along the discs, not out at the windows of the neighbours
Fire	Acrylic is combustible. The LEDs run cool, the drivers are fused and outside the acrylic, and the electrical work is inspected to the festival's technical rules

Installing and removing. The work arrives in three crates: the six discs flat in one A-frame crate (2.3 × 2.3 × 0.7 m, about 600 kg packed); the plinth drum and armature; the LEDs, drivers and spot. The ballast is hired locally. Installation takes one day with a small crane or telehandler and a crew of four: the plinth and ballast set, the discs slotted on, the light commissioned at dusk. Removal takes half a day, and leaves nothing behind.

In brief

Title	[TITLE]
Maker	[OWNER: full name], San Francisco
Size	About 2 m across; the lowest point 0.55 m above the ground on a plinth 1.5 m across. About 485 kg in 25 mm sheet, plus 1.0–1.8 t of ballast in all (est.)
Material	Cell-cast acrylic, 25 mm, tinted through in six colours; a blackened steel plinth, ballasted
Light	24 V rim-lit LED strip (IP67) and one hard spot for the shadow; about 0.4–0.6 kW connected, about 3.5 kWh a night
New or existing	New: made for the festival, at 2 m. A [1.25] m version is [planned / built] [OWNER]
Budget	About €28,000–60,000 (est.) for production, transport, installation and removal, with 15% contingency; low if made in the Netherlands. The artist fee is separate